Product or Service Design

Exam code: 9BS0

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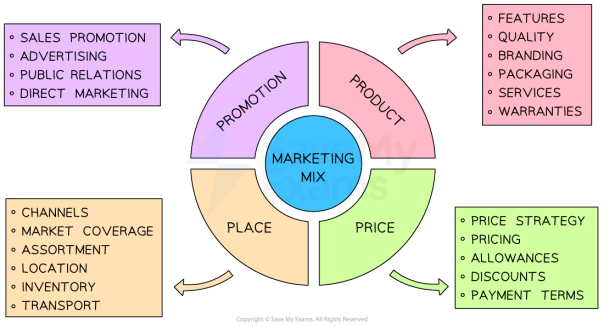
An introduction to the marketing mix

- The **marketing mix** (4Ps of marketing) provides a framework for businesses to create and implement **successful marketing strategies**
- The 4Ps represent the key elements of a marketing strategy
  - **P**roduct
  - **P**rice
  - **P**lace
  - **P**romotion
- These four components work together to satisfy the **needs and wants of a target market** while achieving the company's objectives
  - By understanding and manipulating the marketing mix, businesses can **differentiate themselves** from competitors
- A marketing mix is an essential tool for any company looking to maximise its marketing impact and achieve **long-term success**



Each business combines the different elements of the marketing mix in unique ways to maximise its profitability

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

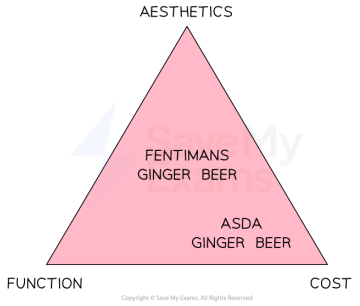
Got it

The design mix

- The product design mix refers to the **combination of elements** that make up a product's design

helps the product design to be both **functional and attractive**, while also being **cost-effective** for both the manufacturer and the consumer
  - Some manufacturers aim to **balance all three elements**
    - For example, Fentimans ginger beer is relatively affordable and is packaged in eye-catching bottles, and the product itself is of very good quality
  - Other manufacturers may **focus on one aspect** more than the others
    - For example, Asda's own brand of ginger beer is produced at the lowest possible cost and sold to consumers at a very low price

The design mix



Fentimans prioritises all three elements of the product design, while Asda focuses on cost

Function

- The function of a product refers to its intended purpose and the specific tasks it is designed to perform
- A product's function is the **most important aspect of its design** because it determines how well the product will **meet the needs** of its intended users
  - For example, a multi-plug adaptor that breaks after one month of use will not be seen by customers to fulfil its function

Aesthetics

- Aesthetics refer to the product's visual and sensory appeal, including its form, shape, colour and texture
- Aesthetics play an important role in attracting customers, creating brand loyalty and generating word-of-mouth recommendations
  - For example, Apple products are well known for their pleasing looks and use of quality materials

Cost

- The cost of production must be considered when designing a product, as it directly affects the price point at which it can be sold
- A well-designed product should balance cost and value, ensuring that customers perceive the product as valuable

cheap to produce and is sold at a very low price

Changes in the design mix to reflect social trends

- Social trends refer to changes in people's attitudes, behaviours and lifestyles
  - Changes to any of these require companies to adapt their products to remain relevant to their customers
- Social trends can significantly impact the **product design mix**, especially regarding concerns over **resource depletion and ethical sourcing**

Social trends that require adaptation of the design mix

Current changes in social trends	Explanation
Concerns about resource depletion	• Customers are becoming increasingly aware of the need to **conserve natural resources** and reduce waste • The product design mix may change to reflect waste minimisation, reuse and recycling • Companies may choose to design products that use **fewer materials**, are **more durable** and **can be easily disassembled for recycling or repair** ○ For example, in October 2020, Superdry announced that all of its jackets would use recycled polyester in their lining (made from plastic bottles) as opposed to new polyester
Concerns about ethical sourcing	• Ethical sourcing means that products are produced **without the exploitation of workers or environmental damage** • Companies may change their product design mix to incorporate sustainable materials and production processes ○ For example, Tony's Chocolonely is committed to producing chocolate that is made from cocoa farmed with **100% slave-free (and child-free) labour**

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